6. The meal planned should consider individual likes and dislikes.
7. Planned meals should provide variety.
8. Meals should give satiety.
9. Menus should include available foods.

There are three steps involved in planning a menu

Step1: Recommended dietary allowance:

To plan a balanced diet the first step is to know the recommended dietary allowances for different age groups.

Steps in menu planning

1. Recommended dietary allowance
2. Food list
   i. Using ICMR tables
   ii. The Exchange list
3. Meal plan

The Recommended Dietary Allowance for Indians ICMR (2010) is given in the Table 2.

Table 2 Recommended Dietary Allowances for Indians (Macronutrients and Minerals)

Group	Particulars	Body wt. kg	Net Energy Kcal/day	Protein g/day	Visible Fat g/day	Calcium mg/day	Iron mg/day
Man	Sedentary work	60	2320	60	25	600	17
	Moderate work		2730		30		
	Heavy work		3490		40		
Women	Sedentary work	55	1900	55	20	600	21
	Moderate work		2230		25		
	Heavy work		2850		30		
	Pregnant Women		+350	82.2	30	1200	35
	Lactation 0 – 6 months		+600	77.9	30	1200	25
	6 – 12 months		+520	70.2	30		
Infants	0 – 6 months	5.4	92 Kcal/kg/d	1.16 g/kg/d	–	500	46 µg/ kg/day
	6 – 12 months	8.4	80 Kcal/kg/d	1.69 g/kg/d	19		5
Children	1 – 3 years	12.9	1060	16.7	27	600	09
	4 – 6 years	18	1350	20.1	25		13
	7 – 9 years	25.1	1690	29.5	30		16
Boys	10 – 12 years	34.3	2190	39.9	35	800	21
Girls	10 – 12 years	35.0	2010	40.4	35	800	27
Boys	13 – 15 years	47.6	2750	54.3	45	800	32
Girls	13 – 15 years	46.6	2330	51.9	40	800	27
Boys	16 – 17 years	55.4	3020	61.5	50	800	28
Girls	16 – 17 years	52.1	2440	55.5	35	800	26

Source: Dietary guidelines of Indians National Institute of Nutrition, Hyderabad, (2010).

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